

KAI MORI

THE BOY WHO WRITES
THE STORIES THAT
SHOULDN'T EXIST.

THE AUTHOR.
THE VESSEL.
THE NEXT HEIR.

07

EPISODE SEVEN

NT/NK

NEVER TELL
NEVER KNOW

遺されたもの

WHAT THE GRANDFATHER LEFT

07: What The Grandfather Left

MANIFEST VELETH

HE WEARS NO FACE,
YET KNOWS YOURS.

HE SPEAKS NO WORDS,
YET WRITES YOUR END.

THE INHERITOR
OF ALL THAT WAS
NEVER MEANT
TO BE INHERITED.

WHO AM I WHEN
THE STORY ENDS?



07 07152035

MA. KAI MORI'S BEDROOM.
SEVERAL NIGHTS AFTER EPISODE 6.



THE BEAP
COPY NOTE.

SITTING CLOSED
EXACTLY WHERE
IT HAS SAT
SINCE THE
GRANDFATHER
FRAGMENT
FIRST
APPEARED.

KAI DOES NOT
LOOK AT IT.

DOES NOT
TOUCH IT.

HE SIMPLY
SHARES THE
ROOM WITH
SOMETHING
HE NO LONGER
TRUSTS.



THE DESK LAMP'S
SINGLE CONE
OF LIGHT
DOES NOT QUITE
REACH THE
NOTEBOOK'S
COVER.



THEN, WITHOUT
HIS HAND MOVING
TOWARD IT,

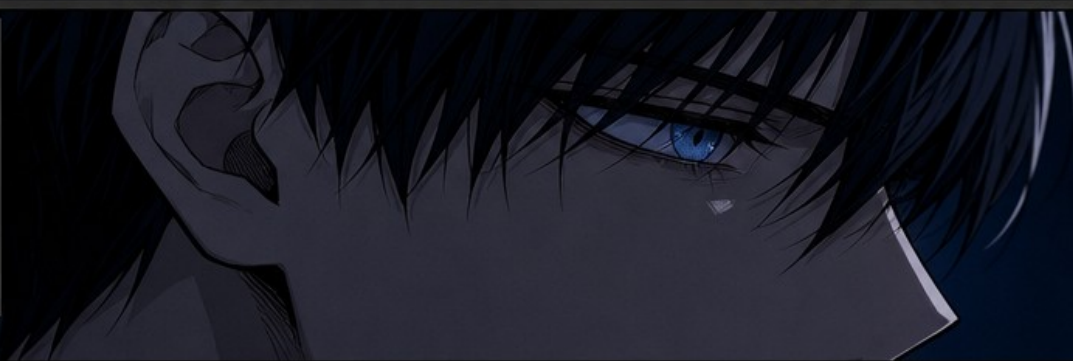
THE COVER
EASES OPEN
A FRACTION
OF AN INCH.
ON ITS OWN.

THE SAME SELF-
OPENING VIOLATION
FIRST SHOWN AT
EPISODE 3'S CLOSE.

KAI DOES
NOT MOVE.

HE SIMPLY
WATCHES IT.

THE SPECIFIC
DREAD OF
SOMEONE WHO
HAS LEARNED
THAT WATCHING
DOES NOT STOP
WHAT IS COMING.



THE GROWING
GAP BETWEEN
PAGES SUGGESTS
SOMETHING
BEYOND HIS
ANALYTICAL REACH
IS OPERATING
IN HIS SPACE.

1.

He trained you before you could

2.

He trained you before you could

3.

Did he choose this for you

4.

THIS IS NOT
COMMUNICATION.

THIS IS DELIBERATE
WOUNDING.

PIECES DESIGNED
TO BREAK ME
SLOWLY.

DISCIPLINE
IS
FREEDOM



He trained you before
you knew how to train.

STORAGE
CLOSET

THE FOLLOWING
AFTERNOON.

I WOULD RATHER
LEARN WHAT I CAN
ON MY OWN TERMS...

...THAN WAIT
FOR THE NOTEBOOK
TO FEED ME MORE
CRUELTY.

GRANDFATHER

WHAT WILL
I FIND?

A CONFESSION?
A LIE?

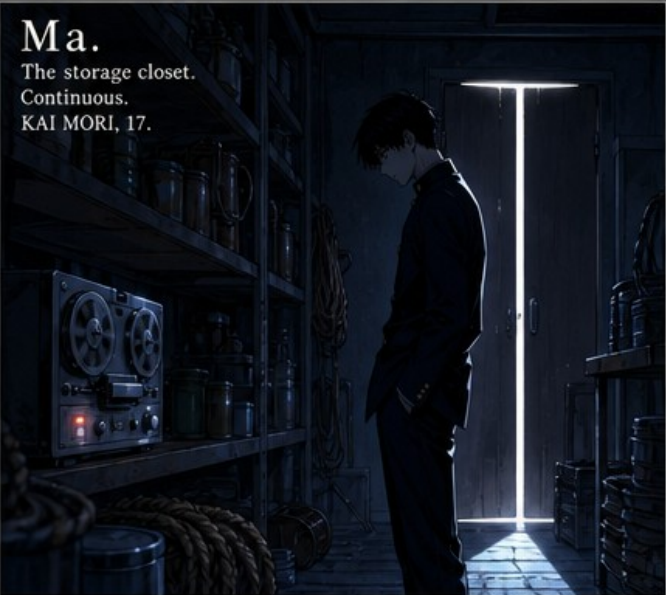
OR THE TRUTH
I WAS NEVER
MEANT TO HEAR?

Ma.

The storage closet.

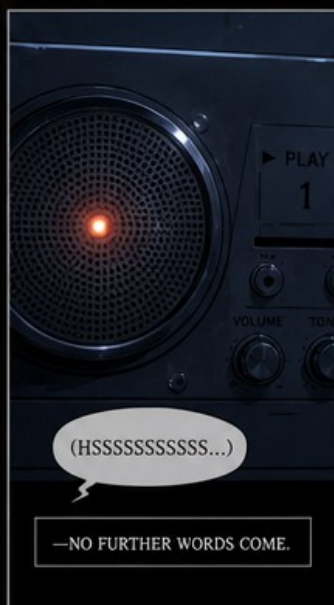
Continuous.

KAI MORI, 17.



...and if he never needs it,
then I did my job twice over.

Better a boy who never has
to see, than one who sees
and has no floor beneath him."



KAI MORI'S HOUSE.
THE NEXT MORNING.

♪...THANK YOU FOR
LISTENING TO
MORNING BREEZE,
HAVE A NICE DAY...♪

AN ORDINARY
MORNING.

SUBJECTIVE ANALYSIS
MODE: ACTIVE

TARGET:
MOTHER
(KAORU MORI)

EMOTIONAL SCAN
COMPREHENSION: 97.3%

DETECTED:
FINANCIAL STRESS
(LONG-TERM)
SEVERITY: MODERATE
DURATION: 8 MONTHS+

DATA STREAM:

HOUSEHOLD EXPENSES
> INCOME MISMATCH
> SAVINGS DEPLETION
> HIDDEN WORRY
> SELF-SACRIFICE PATTERN
> SLEEP DEPRIVATION
> CHRONIC ANXIETY

ANALYSIS COMPLETE
RECOMMENDATION:
INTERVENE?

99.8%

PROBABILITY OF
SILENT ENDURANCE

KAI?

YOU DIDN'T
SLEEP WELL
AGAIN,
DID YOU?

THE FLOOD
HAS BREACHED
THE LAST
SANCTUARY.

SIGHT IS
TRUTH.

TRUTH IS
A WEIGHT.

AND I CANNOT
UNSEE.

EVEN LOVE
IS NOT SAFE
FROM THE
FLOOD.

THE COUNSELLOR.
40s. KIND EYES.
CARDIGAN.

PERFORMATIVE
KINDNESS
AGAINST
THE MACHINERY
SHE REPRESENTS.

KAI MORI.
17.
PERFECT UNIFORM.
PERFECT SILENCE.
PERFECT DISTANCE.

FUJIWARA-SENSEI.
HOMEROOM TEACHER.

GENUINE WORRY.
EQUALLY UNABLE
TO REACH THE
ACTUAL PROBLEM.

A BRIEF, CAREFUL GLANCE
OVER KAI'S HEAD.

THE CODED COMMUNICATION
OF PROFESSIONALS:
CONCERN → ESCALATION →
REFERRAL → DOCUMENTATION

KAI READS IT PERFECTLY.
WITHOUT HIS GIFT.
WITHOUT MOVING.

MICROSECOND
UNDERSTANDING.
SURGICAL PRECISION.

HE UNDERSTANDS:
SOFT MACHINERY
ESCALATING.
NO LONGER JUST
CONCERN.
NOW A PAPER TRAIL.
A FILE.
THE BEGINNING
OF AN INSTITUTIONAL
DIAGNOSIS THAT
WILL FOLLOW HIM
AND EXPLAIN
NOTHING TRUE.

NEITHER ADULT
IS WRONG TO
DISBELIEVE HIM.

NEITHER CAN
HELP HIM
REGARDLESS.

FUJIWARA-SENSEI'S
WORRY HANGS
UNSPOKEN.

HE WANTS TO HELP.

HE KNOWS HE
CANNOT.

KAI, WE'VE
NOTICED SOME
CHANGES.

WE CARE ABOUT
YOU. THAT'S WHY
I INVITED SENSEI
TO JOIN US.

WE WANT
TO SUPPORT
YOU.

I'M FINE.

WE DON'T THINK
YOU ARE.

ROOFTOP.
MAINTENANCE SECTION.
OFF LIMITS.

THE WORM PATH
TELLS ITS OWN STORY.

AFTER THE
COUNSELLOR.

IMPULSE.
NOT EXAMINED.

TUCKED BEHIND
THE TANK'S BASE.

WATERPROOFED.
OLD.
A LOGBOOK.

MAINTENANCE
LOG

!

MAINTENANCE
RECORD...?

AT FIRST,
THAT'S WHAT
I THOUGHT.

UNTIL—

2018. 5. 17.

2018. 6. 2

2018. 6. 16

2018. 7. 3

2018. 8. 11

2018. 9. 1

2018. 10. 4

THE PRESENT.

THROUGH
MY GIFT.

2018. 8. 11

The sky is beautiful today.
I came here again.

IT'S MY HANDWRITING.
MY TWELVE-YEAR-OLD SELF.
ENTRIES I HAVE NO MEMORY
OF WRITING.

SPANNING BACK
FURTHER THAN
MY MEMORY.

DATING TO
WHEN I WAS
TWELVE.

2016. 4. 12.

I hate them.

I don't want to
go back.

2016. 7. 23

Why do
I forget?

2017. 1. 8.

I saw
her face
again.

A CASCADE
OF LOST TIME.

FRACTURED
MEMORY.

2017. 11. 2

I don't
know myself.

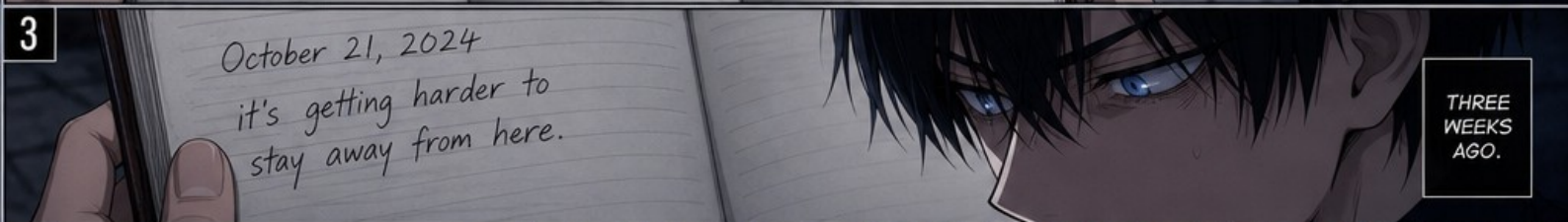
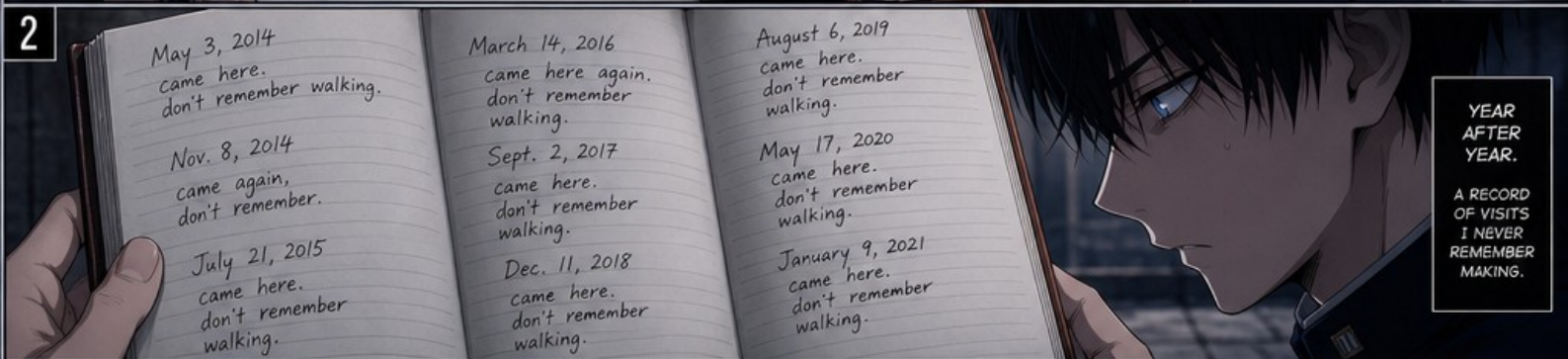
I AM LOSING
MY MIND.

THE LOGBOOK
DOESN'T JUST RECORD
THE PAST.

IT ACCUSES.

KAI MORI, 17

THE ROOFTOP WATER TANK
THE LOGBOOK



THE VELETH CUT

KAI MORI
AGE 17

THAT NIGHT.

KAI MORI
RETURNED
HOME.

SOMETHING
WAS WRONG.
SUBTLY.
UNMISTAKABLY.

HIS ROOM.
HIS ROOM,
EXACTLY.
AS IT HAD
BEEN.

EXCEPT.
IT WASN'T.

HIS DESK.

EIGHT
INCHES.
TO THE
LEFT.

8 in

HIS BOOKSHELF.

ALWAYS
ALPHABETISED.
NOW—

THINGS HE
DOES NOT OWN.

PICTURE BOOKS.
FOR A YOUNGER
CHILD.

THEN—
THE VELETH CUT.

THE WORLD
STUTTERS.

ONE FRAME.
ONE IMPOSSIBILITY.

A PATTERN
THAT WAS
NEVER THERE.
FLORAL.
CHILDISH.

THEN—
GONE.

AS IF IT
NEVER
EXISTED.

THE LIGHT
THROUGH
HIS WINDOW—

WRONG.

WARM.
LOW.

LATE
AFTERNOON.

IT IS
PAST
MIDNIGHT.

PIECE BY PIECE.

THE ROOM
REARRANGES
ITSELF.

INTO A SPACE
HE HAS NOT
OCCUPIED
SINCE HE WAS
SEVEN YEARS OLD.

THE EXACT
AGE HIS
GRANDFATHER
DIED.

KAI MORI
FROZEN.
NOT AFRAID.
ANALYSING.
CATALOGUING.
AN IMPOSSIBILITY.

HIS MIND.
RAZOR SHARP
AGAINST
SOMETHING
BEYOND
REASON.

THE WALLS ARE
BREATHING.

THE DIMENSIONS
ARE COLLAPSING.

THERE'S NO
FIGHTING IT.

ONLY
SURRENDER.

I STEP

THROUGH.

THIS IS
WHERE WE
REHEARSED.

NOT VAELE.
SOMETHING
OLDER.
COLDER.
QUIETER.

SOMETHING
THAT NEVER
LEFT.

SHOW
YOURSELF.

NOTHING.
ONLY THE
STAR'S
GLOW.

ONLY THIS
DOORFRAME
ANCHORS
ME TO
WHAT'S
REAL.

EVERYTHING
ELSE IS
SEVEN
YEARS
GONE.

I WAS
ASLEEP.
A MOMENT
AGO.

THEN IT HIT ME
LIKE A HAMMER
TO THE CHEST.

NOT A
WARNING...

PRESENT
TENSE.

IT'S
HAPPENING.

02:17

NOT
TOMORROW.

NOT SOON.

NOW.

IT'S ALREADY
THERE.

KAI'S
APARTMENT.

I DON'T EVEN
KNOW WHY I'M
CALLING HER.

I JUST KNOW
I HAVE TO.

GRAB

MY HANDS
WON'T
STOP
SHAKING.

TREMBLE

TREMBLE

REIKA TENDO

calling...

mute

keypad

speaker

+

add call

FaceTime

contacts

THE
SECONDS
DRAG.

REIKA TENDO
calling...

00:03

TICK

REIKA TENDO
calling...

00:07

TICK

REIKA TENDO
calling...

00:07

TICK

REIKA TENDO
calling...

00:11

TICK

I SEE THE
FUTURE.

BUT THIS—
THIS ISN'T
FUTURE.

THIS IS NOW.

EACH ONE
A WEIGHT
ON MY
CHEST.

KAI MORI'S BEDROOM.
MINUTES LATER.



I SHOULD
LOOK AWAY.

I SHOULD
SAY
SOMETHING.

BUT SHE
DOESN'T
BLINK.

NOT ONCE.
NOT EVER.

THIS IS
WORSE THAN
ANY BATTLE.

BECAUSE
SHE'S STILL
HERE.

1.

THE PAST
BEHIND BOTH
OUR CLOSED
EYES.

SHARED.
WHOLE.
AT LAST.



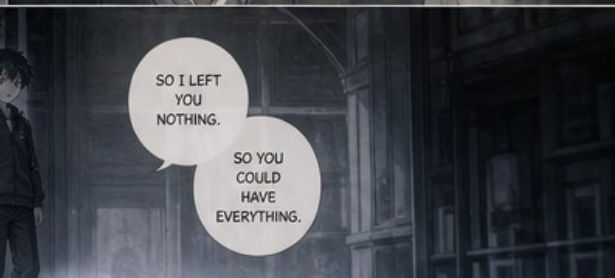
2.

THE LESSONS
THAT BUILT
ME.
NOT POWER.
TRUTH.
OVER AND
OVER.



3.

HIS FINAL
ACT.
NOTHING,
BECAUSE
I WAS NOT
READY.
PROTECTION
IN SILENCE.



4.

THE VISION
COMPLETE.
NOTHING LEFT
UNSAID.
NOTHING LEFT
TO WEAPONIZE.
ONLY THE
TRUTH.
WHOLE.
OURS.



KAI MORI'S BEDROOM.
AFTER THE VISION.



I DIDN'T
KNOW
HOW MUCH
I NEEDED
SOMEONE TO
ALREADY
KNOW.

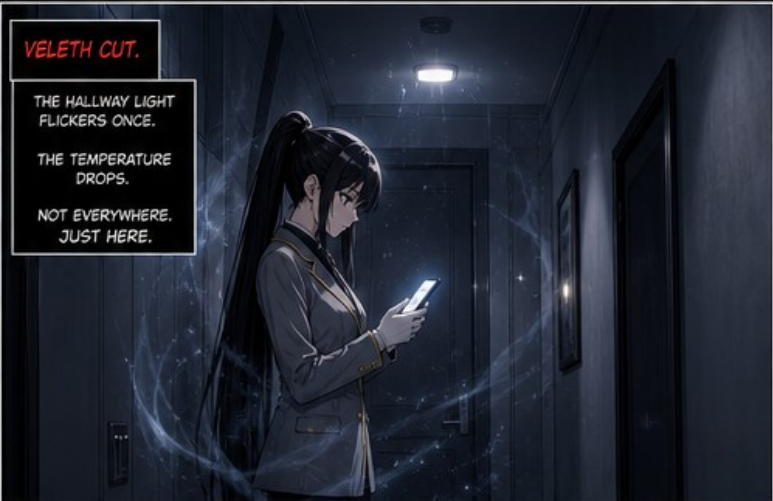
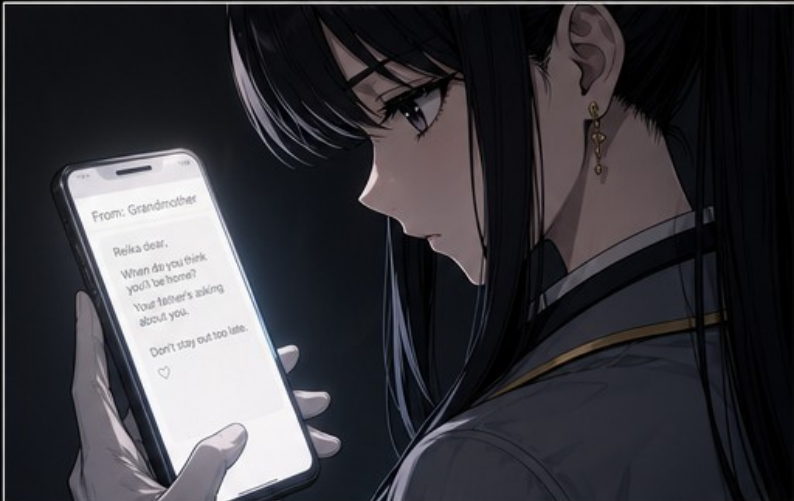


THE SILENCE HOLDS.
THREE PEOPLE.
ONE MOMENT.
NO ONE FALLS.



EPISODE 7: VELETH CUT
LATER.

REIKA TENDO AND
SORA MINASE
STEPPED OUT TO
GIVE KAI A MOMENT
ALONE BEFORE THEY
ALL LEAVE TOGETHER.

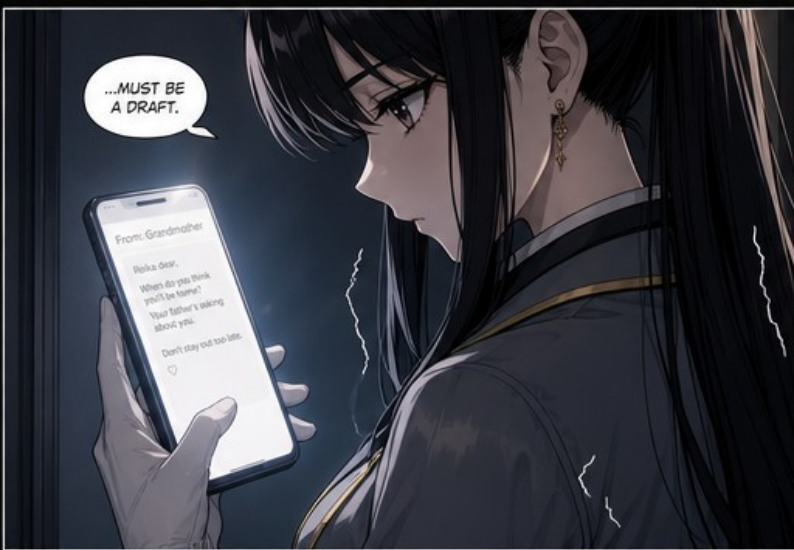


VELETH CUT.

THE HALLWAY LIGHT
FLICKERS ONCE.

THE TEMPERATURE
DROPS.

NOT EVERYWHERE.
JUST HERE.



IT HAD LOST THIS ROUND.
IT WAS ALREADY LOOKING
FOR THE **NEXT DOOR**.